Q+A

IN THE BEST LIGHT

*Not all artists enjoy the success that **Paresh Maity** does. Take his new exhibition,* Infinite Light, *as a premise. On view in four different cities, the show puts on display both the artist's output and tenacity*

Q. Why the name 'Infinite Light'?
More than 50 years ago, when I was only seven, growing up in my hometown of Tamluk, I realised there is no life without light. Even today, I like sitting out and enjoying the light at all times of day, be it noon or twilight. Light is so integral to visual communication and to visual art. That is why this title.

Q. Your exhibition is being held in four cities–Delhi (Art Alive Gallery), Mumbai (Art Musings), Kolkata (CIMA), Bengaluru (Gallery Sumukha). How does it feel to be everywhere all at once?
I wanted to show my exhibition to the four corners of India. I wanted people to see the amalgamation of my 32 years of work. Also, given the number of people who usually come for my exhibitions, and the number of works on display–450, in total–I felt the vision for this retrospective must be different.

Q. You've found success in diverse mediums–sculpture, painting, installation. Is there a favourite?
That's like asking a mother to name her favourite child. I love to explore every medium, be it sculpture or watercolour. My idea is to make art out of anything, even chairs or clothes. I don't feel it must be limited to paper or canvas.

Q. You have painted Banaras repeatedly. Does it live up to its magic today?
From every moment in Banaras there emerges a new magic, a new language, a new light. That city is beyond history. Banaras engages your thoughts, your every sensation. Find yourself a stair to sit on in Banaras and you'll see the whole world, everything from birth to death.

with Shreevatsa Nevatia

MANDAR DEODHAR